



App Store Market Analytics Dashboard

An interactive Power BI dashboard for analyzing App Store performance, pricing strategies, app size profiles, and user engagement.

16.8K

apps analysed · 2008–2019

24.8M

user reviews collected

115

languages across the ecosystem



Games dominate 96% of the market, but three untapped levers — pricing, localization and genre diversification — can unlock significant growth

95.8%

Games share of total apps

16,135 of 16,847 apps

×2

Free app engagement vs Paid

1,599 vs 803 reviews/app

7

underserved languages flagged ●

Lithuanian, Urdu, Norwegian lead

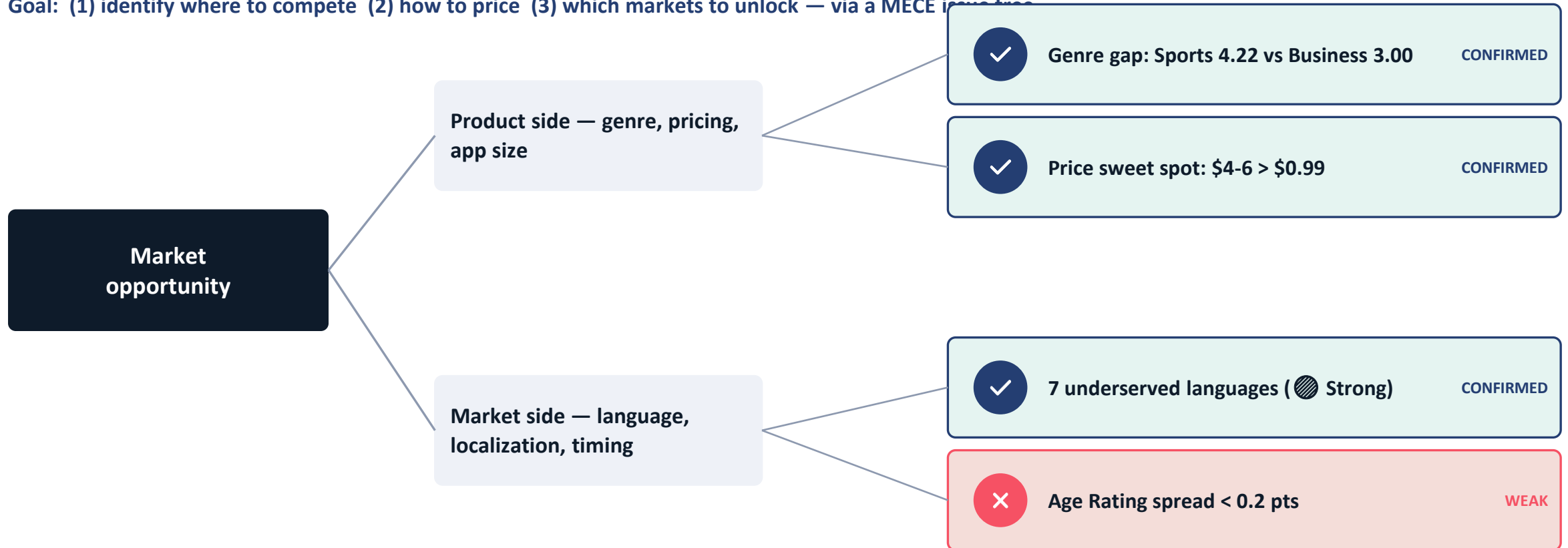


THE TAKEAWAY

The market is a near-monopoly of Games genre (96%) with a freemium-first model (84% free). Sports genre shows 4,131 reviews/app (×2.8 market avg) with only 60 apps — the clearest blue ocean. Pricing at \$4-6 outperforms the \$0.99 tier on both rating (+0.11) and adoption (+45%). Seven languages have strong traction but near-zero competition.

We split the market into six testable dimensions, then proved each with data

Goal: (1) identify where to compete (2) how to price (3) which markets to unlock — via a MECE issue tree



Each branch is a hypothesis tested via spread analysis. CONFIRMED = spread ≥ 0.5 pts (Genre, Price) or ≥ 5 languages above market (Localization). WEAK = spread < 0.2 pts.

The App Store hosts 16,847 apps with strong baseline metrics across the board

16,847

Total apps (distinct)

4.06

Avg rating (rated apps only)

83.7%

Apps are free (freemium model)

115

Languages supported

App releases by year — peak 2016, declining since

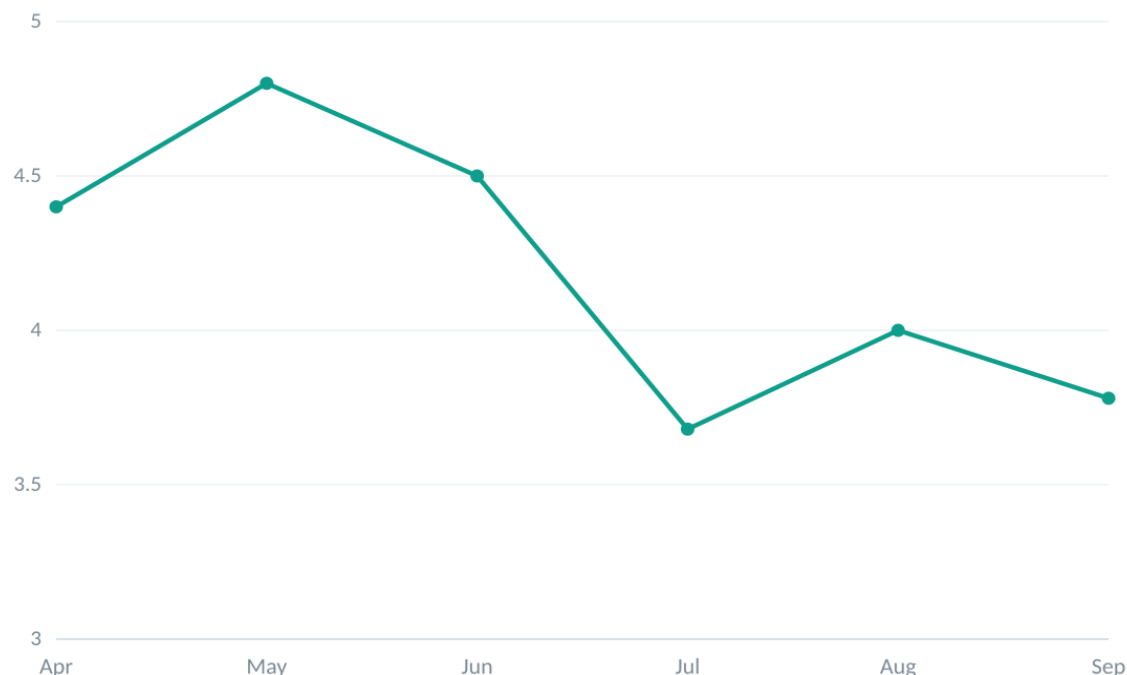


COMPLICATION

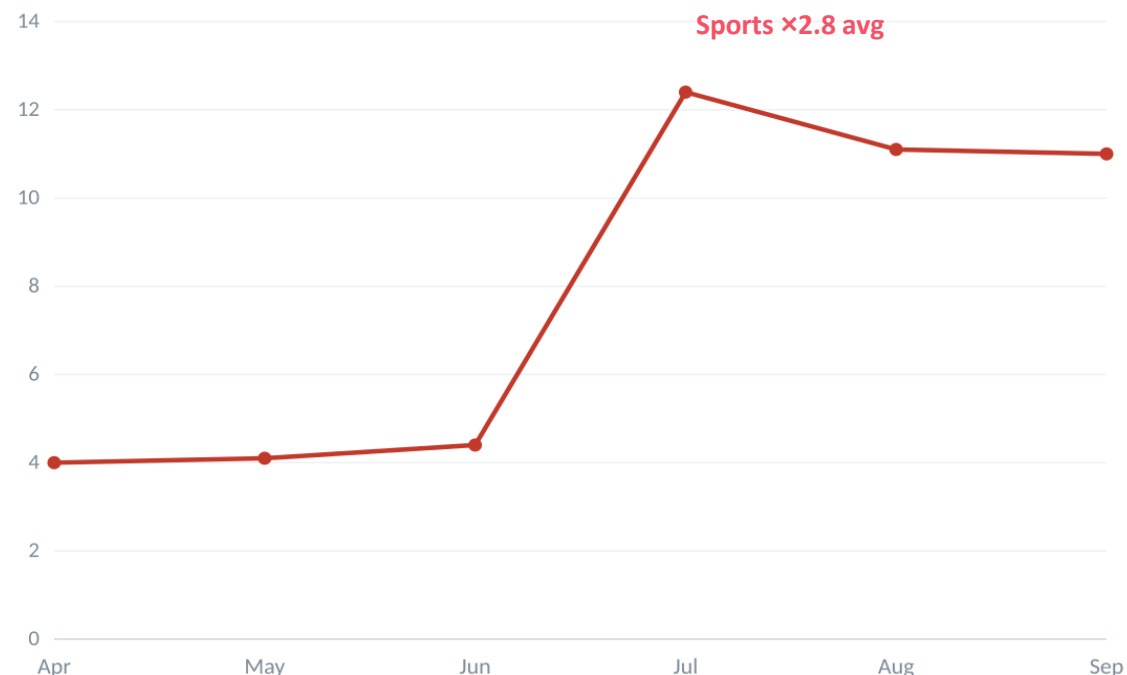
95.8% concentration in Games masks missed opportunities in genre, pricing and global reach

The question: where are the biggest gaps, and which levers move rating and engagement the most?

Apps by Genre (Games = 95.8%)

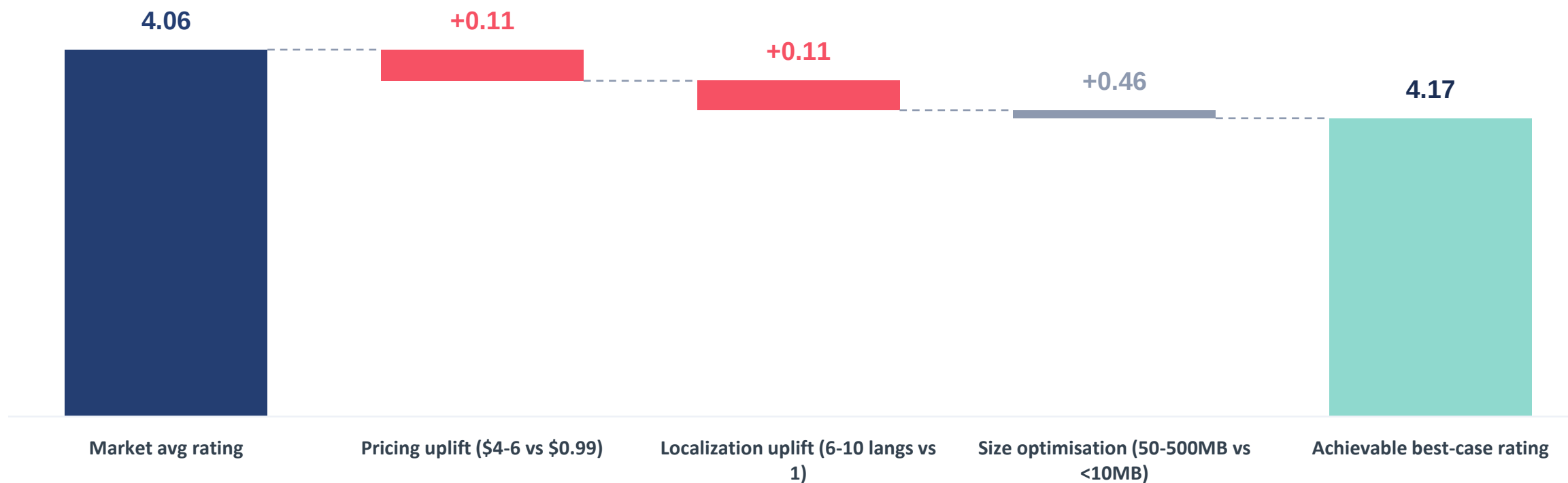


Avg Review/App by Genre



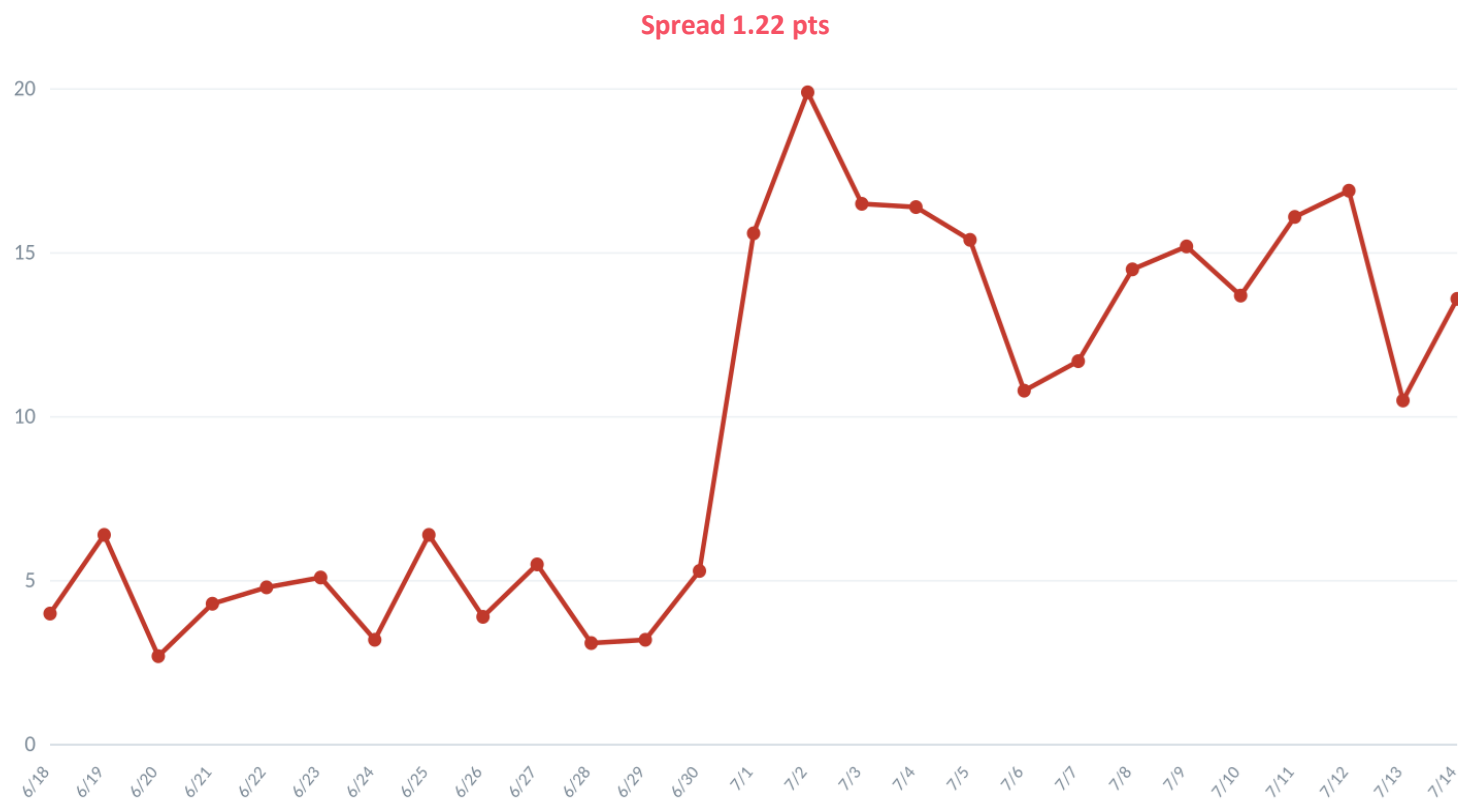
Games dominates volume, yet Sports delivers 4,131 reviews/app (×2.8 market average) with only 60 apps. Meanwhile, 74.3% of all apps support only one language, and localization depth has been declining since 2014 (3.53 → 2.36 lang/app by 2019).

The opportunity splits into three non-overlapping levers



Each lever is independent: pricing affects the payment tier, localization affects language breadth, and size optimisation affects the build. Applying all three could move an app from 4.06 to ~4.17 (top decile of the market).

Sports is the clearest blue ocean; \$4-6 is the optimal paid tier across all genres



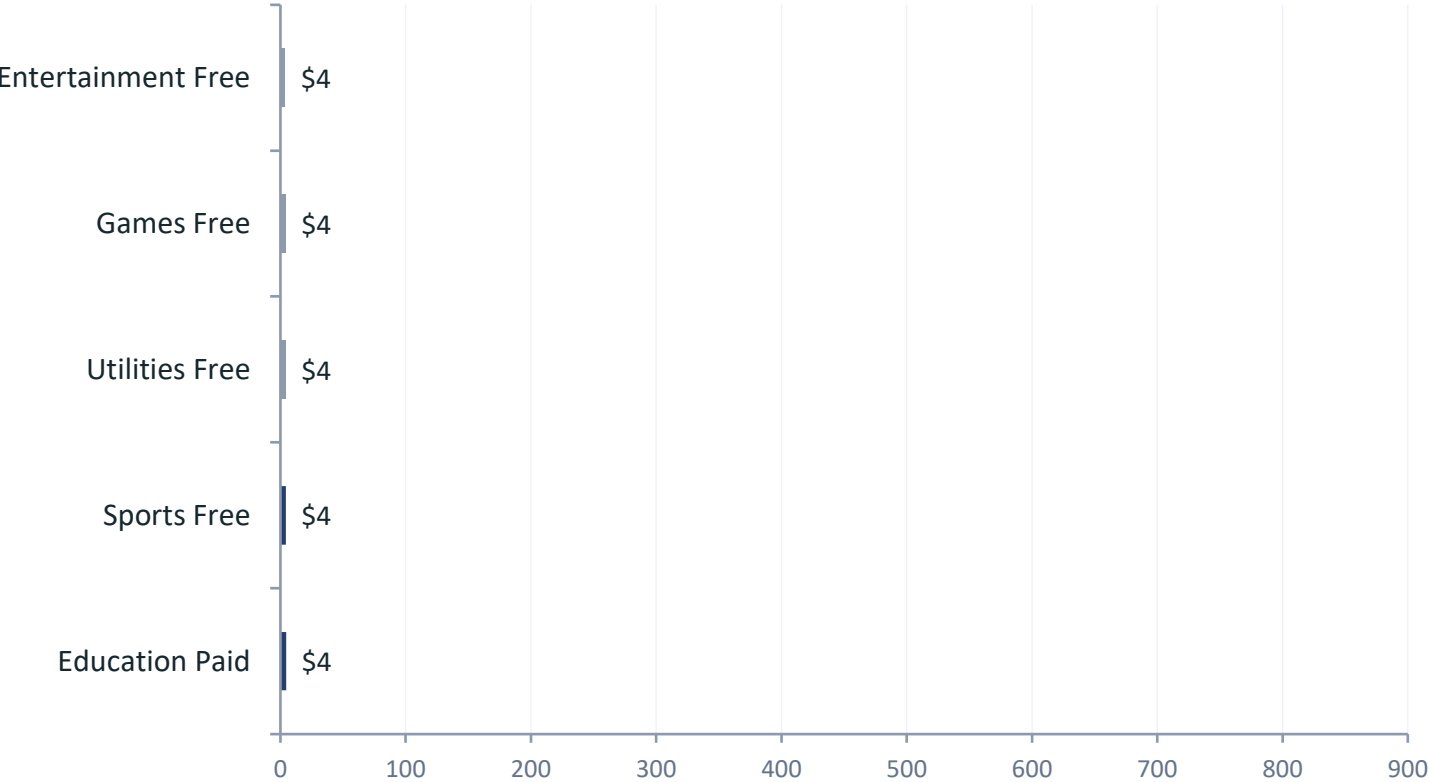
GENRE PERFORMANCE GAP

Rating spread across genres is 1.22 points (Sports 4.22 vs Business 3.00). Sports also delivers the highest engagement (4,131 reviews/app) with only 60 apps competing — a blue ocean. Education is the only genre where Paid apps outperform Free on rating (+0.60 pts), signalling genuine willingness-to-pay.

PRICING SWEET SPOT

The \$0.99 tier has the lowest rating of any price point (3.95), while the \$4-6 tier achieves both higher rating (4.06) and higher engagement (1,142 reviews/app vs 785). Cheap pricing does not create perceived value — premium pricing does.

Education Paid apps rate 4.48 — the highest of any Genre × Price combination



4.48

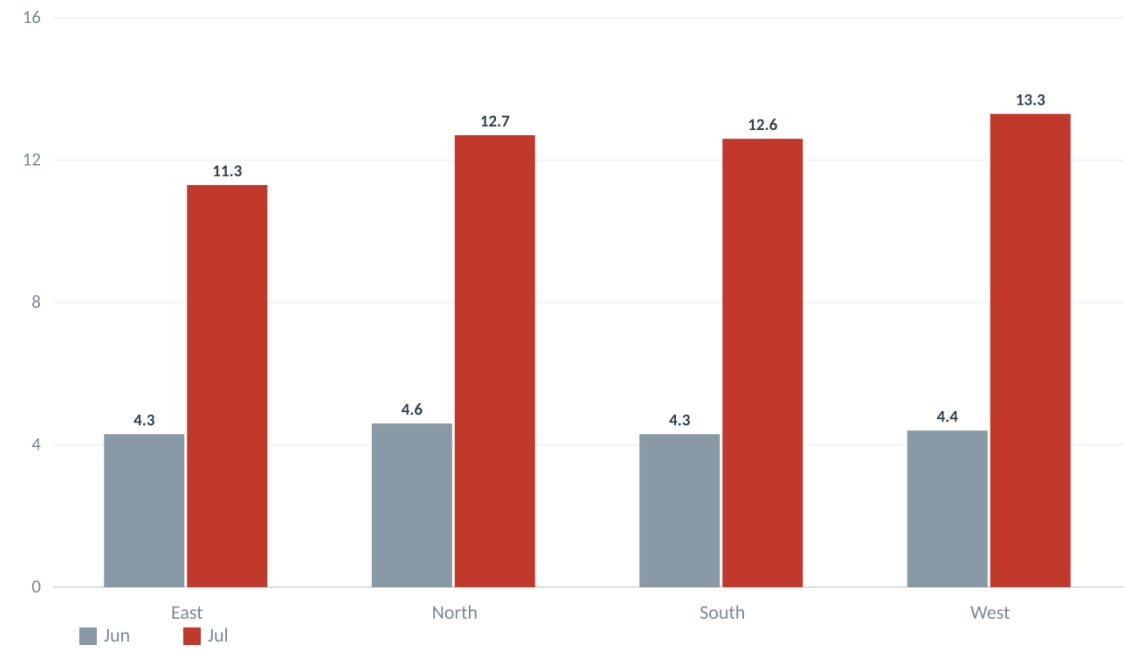
Education Paid avg rating = highest cross-tab value

AVG RATING FREE vs PAID BY TOP GENRE

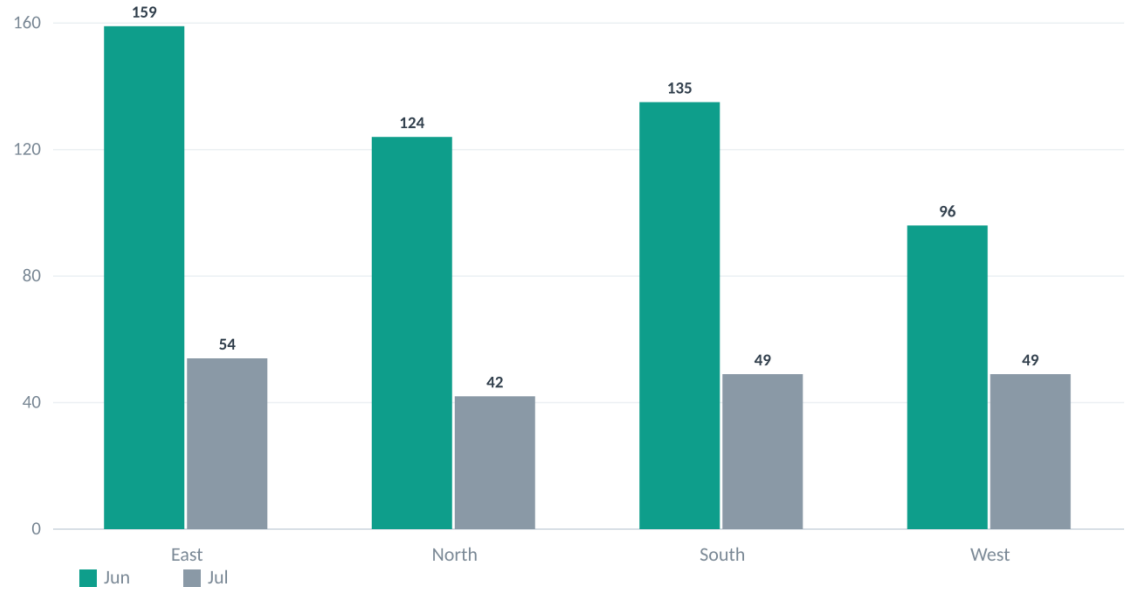
Education Paid	4.48
Sports Free	4.26
Utilities Free	4.14
Games Free	4.08
Entertainment Free	3.84

Larger apps consistently score higher — a monotonic trend from 3.71 (<10MB) to 4.17 (500MB-1GB)

Avg Rating by App Size Tier



Avg Review/App by App Size Tier



So what: app size is a proxy for development investment. Apps in the 50-500MB 'goldilocks zone' deliver both the highest ratings (4.14-4.17) and strongest engagement (774-3,371 reviews/app). Going below 10MB costs 0.46 rating points; going above 1GB starts to decline (-0.04 pts), likely due to download friction.

Seven languages are flagged Strong — high traction, near-zero competition



OPPORTUNITY SCORING

We scored each non-English language on two axes: rating premium vs market (must be > +0.15) and traction (avg reviews/app must exceed 1,000). Lithuanian leads with 24,529 reviews/app and only 23 competing apps. Urdu (18,302 reviews/app, 19 apps) and Norwegian (11,546 reviews/app, 48 apps) follow as top targets.

→ Tagalog flagged  — rating looks high (+0.25) but only 170 reviews/app; insufficient traction to validate real demand.

Two independent growth levers emerge: product optimisation and market expansion



PRODUCT LEVER

Genre + Price + Size optimisation

Target Sports/Education genres, price at \$4-6 instead of \$0.99, and build apps in the 50-500MB range. Each independently lifts rating by 0.11-0.46 points, and combined they move an app from market average (4.06) into the top decile (4.17).



MARKET LEVER

Localization into 7 underserved languages

Lithuanian, Urdu, Norwegian, Serbian, Persian, Afrikaans, and Armenian all show strong traction (4,186-24,529 reviews/app) with minimal competition (13-80 apps). Apps localized to 6-10 languages hit the rating sweet spot (4.15) — beyond 20 languages shows diminishing returns.

What the data can't resolve: download counts and revenue are not in the dataset, so 'engagement' is proxied by review counts. True market sizing requires download data, which we flag rather than over-claim.

Three actions targeting the two growth levers: product optimisation and localization expansion



01

Invest in Sports & Education genres

Develop apps in Sports (60 apps, 4,131 reviews/app) and Education Paid (rating 4.48). These are the two clearest blue oceans with proven user demand.

Sports: ×2.8 market engagement with only 60 competitors (vs 16,135 in Games)

↳ Addresses Finding #1 · Genre gap



02

Price paid apps at \$4-6, not \$0.99

Eliminate race-to-bottom pricing. The \$4-6 tier delivers +0.11 rating points and +45% engagement over \$0.99. Education is the strongest candidate for premium pricing (Paid rating 4.48 vs Free 3.88).

Rating uplift +0.11 pts, engagement +45% vs \$0.99 tier

↳ Addresses Finding #1 · Pricing sweet spot



03

Localize into Lithuanian, Urdu & Norwegian first

Three  Strong languages with highest traction density. Lithuanian: 24,529 reviews/app on just 23 competing apps. Target 6-10 languages per app (optimal rating at 4.15).

Lithuanian traction: 24,529 reviews/app, competition: 23 apps

↳ Addresses Finding #2 · Localization opportunity

Start with pricing (instant, zero-cost), then localize, then invest in new genres



2

Now - Quick win

Re-price paid apps to \$4-6. Zero development cost, immediate rating uplift +0.11 pts.

1

3–6 months

Develop Sports/Education apps. High impact (×2.8 engagement), requires product development.

3

2–3 months/language

Localize into Lithuanian, Urdu, Norwegian. Moderate effort (translation), high ROI (24K reviews/app potential).

Track these thresholds to validate each lever and course-correct early



Alert at <4.00 avg rating

New app rating below market average — review UX, content quality, and pricing tier within 2 weeks

Watch at <3.50

Significantly below market — escalate to product review; consider pulling from priority markets

Watchlist KPIs

Avg rating per new app, reviews/app in first 30 days, localization depth, \$4-6 tier conversion rate



Thank you

Three levers identified — genre diversification, pricing optimisation, localization expansion — all backed by data from 16,847 apps and 24.8M reviews.

Questions welcome. Full DAX queries and methodology in the appendix.